



CARDLOGIX

AI-Driven Business Development Blueprint

Two tracks: your own IT, and a phishing-resistant MFA channel partnership

Prepared for CardLogix Corporation

Prepared by Technijian | 2026-05-30

Irvine, California — neighbors in the Spectrum

CONFIDENTIAL — Prepared exclusively for CardLogix. Projections are estimated and calibrate to real figures after a discovery call.

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01 Executive Summary

1998

CardLogix building secure credentials

3 waves

MFA mandates: federal → state/local → private (insurance)

2

Tracks: your own IT + a channel partnership

5 min

Apart in the Irvine Spectrum

CardLogix makes the credentials that secure identity — PIV cards, FIDO2 smart cards, FRAC cards for first responders, and the BIOSID biometric kits behind them. Since 1998, from Irvine, it has shipped NIST-certified, GSA-approved hardware through a network of integrators and resellers. The hardware is excellent. What sits around the hardware — the managed IT that runs CardLogix internally, and the managed-services delivery that an end agency needs to actually put those cards to work — is where this blueprint focuses.

This document is deliberately built on two tracks, because CardLogix presents two distinct, real opportunities. The first is close to home: CardLogix runs its own IT with a small internal team and has weighed co-managed support before. The second is strategic: a regulatory shift has made CardLogix's core products mandatory for an entire market — and that market needs a managed-services partner CardLogix does not currently bring to the table.

Track A is CardLogix's own environment — a co-managed IT engagement sized to a lean team, where Technijian extends coverage and senior expertise without displacing the person who runs IT today. Track B is a channel partnership: CardLogix supplies the phishing-resistant credentials, and Technijian wraps the managed IT, security operations, compliance program, and certificate authority around them for the customers who must now meet MFA requirements — law-enforcement agencies under CJIS first, and increasingly private companies pushed by their cyber-insurers. AI runs underneath both — as account intelligence, audit-evidence automation, and authority content aimed at the specific buyers each track serves.

The Core Opportunity

Track A (your IT): a co-managed engagement sized to CardLogix's footprint — we assume roughly 6 managed workstations and 2 servers today — a card manufacturer's headcount typically spans production and floor roles beyond the managed-desktop fleet, and the exact count firms up at the free assessment — senior coverage and after-hours help that extends your internal team, priced to be an easy first step rather than an enterprise retainer.

Track B (the partnership): MFA has gone from recommended to required in three waves — federal, then state/local and law enforcement (CJIS, mandatory since October 1, 2024), and now private companies pushed by cyber-insurance renewals. CardLogix's cards satisfy that requirement; what customers still need is a partner to deploy and run them — the role Nick indicated CardLogix wants Technijian to play (subject to Goulet/Hope sign-off).

AI is the layer under both tracks — account intelligence on named agencies and integrators, AI-assisted compliance evidence, and authority content for the exact questions CJIS buyers ask. This is account-based by design, not broad lead generation.

This blueprint follows our conversation on May 29, 2026. In that call, Nick Schooler confirmed the managed-MFA / certificate-authority offering is a service CardLogix wants to extend to its own customers with Technijian delivering it — so Track B below is grounded in a real, stated intent, not a cold pitch. The figures remain estimates pending discovery, but the direction is the client's, not ours alone.

An honest note up front, carried throughout this document: Technijian has built deep practices in eight compliance frameworks, but CJIS is not yet one of them. We treat CJIS as a near-term build — closely adjacent to the CMMC practice we already run — and a partnership with CardLogix is exactly the trigger that would justify standing it up. We do not claim CJIS delivery experience we have not earned.

02 Where the Growth Comes From — Two Tracks

Before any tactics, one question shapes the whole plan: where does the next dollar of value actually come from? For CardLogix there are two answers, and they are different enough that the program treats them as separate tracks running in parallel — one fast and close to home, one strategic and built over a few quarters.

	Track A — CardLogix's Own IT	Track B — CJIS / MFA Partnership
What it is	Co-managed IT for a lean internal team (about 5–6 workstations and 2 servers)	A channel partnership: CardLogix supplies the credentials, Technijian wraps managed IT, SOC, and CJIS-compliance around them for agency end-customers
Who decides	Nick Schooler can champion and likely sign	Sebastien Goulet (CEO) and Tom Hope (Sales) — Nick warms the door
Time to value	Weeks, once scope is agreed	A few quarters — needs at least one joint pilot
Confidence	High — this is what co-managed IT is built for	Nick expressed strong interest in our 2026-05-29 conversation in offering this as a joint, customer-facing service — subject to Goulet/Hope sign-off; a pilot proves delivery
Where AI fits	Operational automation, monitoring, knowledge capture	Account intelligence, compliance-evidence automation, authority content

Two Tracks, One Relationship

Track A is the land: a small, well-scoped co-managed engagement that solves a real internal pain and proves how Technijian works — neighbors who answer the phone, not an offshore queue.

Track B is the expansion: a partnership where CardLogix's hardware and Technijian's managed-services wrap together become a complete answer for CJIS-bound agencies — a story neither side tells alone today.

They are sequenced on purpose. Track A earns the trust and the working rhythm; Track B is the larger, slower prize that the working relationship makes credible.

03 The Market Shift Behind the Partnership

The partnership exists because of a real demand wave that Nick described directly in our conversation — and it is wider than law enforcement. Strong multi-factor authentication moved from "recommended" to "required" in three waves, each pulling a new segment of the market toward exactly the kind of credential CardLogix makes.

- **Wave 1 — Federal.** Federal agencies were required to implement multi-factor authentication first (roughly three years ago), establishing PIV / smart-card credentials as the government standard.
- **Wave 2 — State & local.** The requirement flowed down to state and local government — and, for law enforcement specifically, the FBI's CJIS Security Policy 5.9.5 made MFA mandatory for access to criminal-justice information as of October 1, 2024, with version 6.0 (December 2024) tightening it toward phishing-resistant methods.
- **Wave 3 — Private sector (the big one).** Now private companies are being pulled in — not by a government rule, but by their insurers: renewing ransomware / cybersecurity insurance increasingly requires MFA to be in place. That makes the addressable market far larger than agencies alone.

There is a second shift inside the first: which kind of MFA counts. As Nick put it, many organizations rely on Cisco Duo or Okta with codes pushed to phones — and phones get compromised, with the added headache of whether the device is company-owned or personal. Phishing-resistant, hardware-bound credentials are the durable answer, and CardLogix's reasoning is simple: in these environments people already carry a badge, so the credential rides on something they already have. PKI smart cards and FIDO2 satisfy the strongest requirements where phone-based one-time codes no longer do — and that is precisely the CardLogix product line (PIV, FIDO2, FRAC).

The implication is the same across all three waves. Whether it is a small police department under CJIS or a private company satisfying its insurer, the buyer often has thin or outsourced IT and limited capacity to deploy and operate the solution. The credential is necessary but

not sufficient: it must be issued, bound to an identity, integrated with the customer's directory (for example certificate-based authentication into Microsoft Entra ID, working alongside — not bypassing — Microsoft's own MFA), and operated with logging, access control, incident response, and audit around it. That operational wrap is the gap — and it is what CardLogix asked Technijian to fill.

Why CardLogix Cannot Capture This Alone

CardLogix sells through integrators and resellers — it makes and programs the cards, but does not deliver the customer's managed IT, security operations, ongoing compliance, or the certificate authority behind the credential.

The larger incumbent, HID Global, wins partly because it can point to a full ecosystem around the credential. CardLogix's competitive gap is not the card; it is the absence of a managed-services partner it can hand off to.

Technijian can be that partner on the channel side — turning "buy our card" into "we will stand up and run the secure, compliant environment your card lives in, including the certificate authority." That is a stronger, jointly-owned offer that works for an LE agency under CJIS and for a private company satisfying its cyber-insurer alike.

Honesty matters here as much as ambition. Technijian's My Compliance practice supports eight frameworks today — HIPAA, SOC 2, PCI-DSS, CMMC/DFARS, GDPR/CCPA, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, and ISO 27001. CJIS is not yet among them. The reason this is still credible is adjacency: CJIS shares control families, an evidence model, and an audit posture with CMMC, which Technijian already runs on a foundation of Microsoft Entra ID, Microsoft Defender, conditional access, insider-risk monitoring, and documented IT operations. A CardLogix partnership is exactly the reason to formalize a CJIS wrapper on top of that foundation. This document positions CJIS as a near-term capability to build together, never as a track record to claim.

The CJIS Practice Build — A Dated Plan, Not a Promise

Because "we'll build it" is not something Nick can take to Goulet, here is the actual plan — mapped onto the CMMC foundation already in place, timed to the first joint pilot rather than left open-ended:

- **Month 1 — Control mapping.** Map the CJIS Security Policy (v5.9.5 / 6.0) control families onto the existing CMMC control set and the Entra ID + Defender + conditional-access stack we already operate; produce the CJIS gap map (the free Nexus Assess seeds this).
- **Month 2 — Evidence + policy.** Stand up the CJIS evidence model and the policy/procedure set; configure logging, access control, and incident-response artifacts to CJIS requirements.
- **Month 3 — Mock audit on the pilot.** Run the first joint LE-agency pilot under the wrapper and dry-run a CJIS audit against it — the reusable proof point for every deal after.
- **Ongoing — Formalize + staff.** Promote the wrapper to a standing CJIS practice inside My Compliance, with CJIS-trained, US-based, background-screened personnel on any CJI-touching work.

It is a build measured in months, not years, and the partnership is what triggers it — but the path, the owner, and the milestones are concrete, not aspirational. CJIS work is scoped to the first pilot before any multi-agency commitment, and every CJI-touching task is handled by US-based, background-screened staff.

The Cost of Waiting

This window does not stay open indefinitely. The MFA mandates are already live — CJIS has required it for criminal-justice access since October 1, 2024 — so agencies and insurance-driven private buyers are choosing managed-services partners now, not later. Every quarter CardLogix waits to put a delivery wrap behind its credentials is a quarter the larger incumbent, HID Global, gets to answer the "who runs it after we sell it?" question for those buyers first — and the partner an agency picks for its first CJIS deployment is hard and expensive to displace afterward. The white space is open today; it does not stay open while competitors build their own delivery story. The cost of waiting is not zero — it is a deal defaulting to the vendor with the more complete answer.

04 The Buyer Map

This is an account-based opportunity, not a broad market. The people who move it are a small, nameable set — inside CardLogix for both tracks, and across a finite group of agencies and integrators for the partnership. The map below orders them by influence and by how ready each is to engage now, so effort goes where it converts.

1 — Nick Schooler · Business Development

Role	CardLogix's business-development lead and, today, the person who runs internal IT. Technical, deeply versed in smart-card technology.
What He Feels	The toil of running IT solo for a growing shop — after-hours issues, patching, user provisioning, second-pair-of-eyes on anything unusual.
Decision Driver	Track A that removes work without taking away his control; a partnership idea he can champion without overcommitting his executives.
Where AI Helps	Operational automation and monitoring on Track A; account intelligence he can put in front of Goulet and Hope on Track B.
Technijian Hook	My IT (Co-Managed) for his environment; a tight partnership concept he can carry upward when he is ready.

2 — Sebastien Goulet · Chairman & CEO

Role	Final decision-maker for any partnership-level commitment. Not in the first conversation; reached through Nick.
What He Cares About	Whether a partnership wins more agency deals and strengthens CardLogix against HID — without diluting the brand or adding overhead.
Decision Driver	A credible, low-risk path to a joint go-to-market with proof, not a slide deck of promises.
Where AI Helps	Evidence: a modeled view of the pipeline a managed-services wrap opens, grounded in the CJIS mandate and named target agencies.
Technijian Hook	The partnership concept — earned after Track A shows Technijian executes.

3 — Tom Hope · Director of Sales

Role	Owns CardLogix's commercial relationships and channel. Central to making a co-sell motion real.
What He Cares About	Whether the partnership helps his integrators close, shortens sales cycles, and answers the "who runs it after we sell it?" objection.
Decision Driver	A repeatable co-sell play his channel can actually use, not a one-off.
Where AI Helps	Trigger monitoring on agency grant cycles and audit deadlines; per-account dossiers his team and integrators can act on.
Technijian Hook	My AI account-intelligence engine feeding the channel; joint enablement material.

4 — The LE Agency IT Director (Joint End-Customer)

Role	The person inside a police department, sheriff's office, or agency responsible for meeting CJIS and keeping officers working.
What They Feel	A mandate they must meet, thin internal IT, and uncertainty about how to deploy and operate phishing-resistant MFA.
Decision Driver	A single accountable partner who delivers the cards and runs the compliant environment around them.
Where AI Helps	Authority content that answers their exact CJIS questions; AI-assisted onboarding and audit-evidence packs.
Technijian Hook	The joint CardLogix + Technijian offer: hardware plus a managed, CJIS-aligned environment.

5 — The Prime Integrator / Reseller (Channel Partner)

Role	The integrators and resellers CardLogix already sells through (the channel that reaches agencies).
What They Care About	Closing more agency deals and not owning the managed-IT obligation themselves.
Decision Driver	A managed-services partner they can attach to a card sale to complete the offer.
Where AI Helps	Shared account intelligence and co-branded authority content that lifts the whole channel.

Technijian Hook

Technijian as the named managed-services partner in the channel motion.

Figure 4.0 maps each buyer by influence over the opportunity and readiness to engage now — showing whom to warm first (Nick), whom to reach through him (Goulet, Hope), and whom the partnership activates (agencies and integrators).

The Joint Go-to-Market Buyer Map

Who moves the CardLogix x Technijian partnership — and in what order to engage them

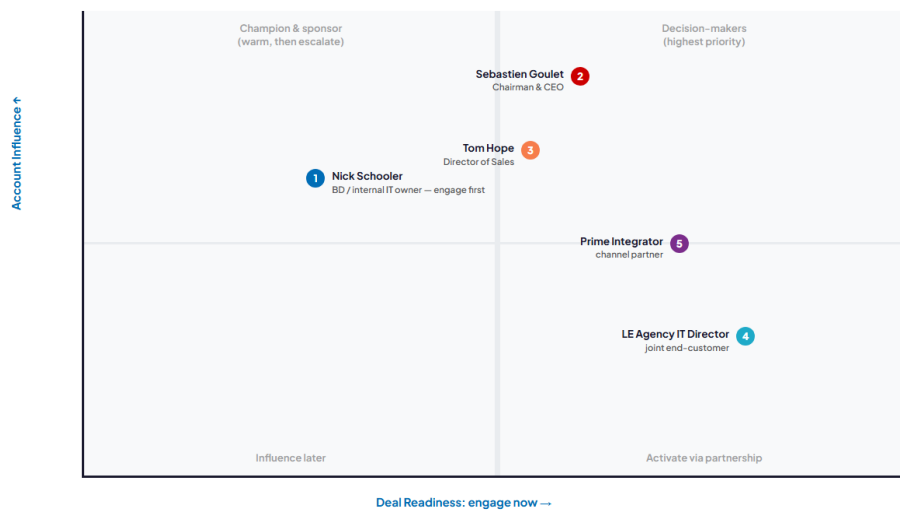


Figure 4.0 — The Joint Go-to-Market Buyer Map: Account Influence vs. Deal Readiness

05 Competitive Landscape

The question for the partnership is not who makes the best card — CardLogix competes well there. It is who can offer an agency the complete answer: the credential plus the managed environment around it. Seen that way, the landscape has an obvious open lane.

Vendor	Position	Relevant to the Partnership
HID Global	The incumbent; full identity ecosystem	Wins partly on a complete ecosystem around the credential. A CardLogix + Technijian managed-services wrap is the most direct answer to that advantage.
Identiv	Hirsch uTrust FIDO2 (CardLogix resells this)	A partner-and-peer overlap; underlines that hardware alone is increasingly commoditized — the managed wrap is the differentiator.
Tx Systems	CJIS-focused smart-card distributor	Competes for the same channel position; does not bring a managed-IT/SOC delivery arm.
Yubico	YubiKey FIDO2 — the volume MFA pick	Many buyers choose YubiKey to satisfy MFA cheaply, without PIV depth. CardLogix wins on credentialing-grade depth; the partnership wins on delivery.
Phone-based MFA (Cisco Duo, Okta)	The incumbent being displaced	The real status quo for most customers: one-time codes pushed to phones. Phones get compromised, and company-vs-personal device ownership is a headache. The phishing-resistant credential — riding the badge people already carry — is the upgrade path, and the joint offer is how it gets deployed.
CardLogix + Technijian	Hardware + managed credential environment	Credentialing-grade cards plus a single accountable partner to deploy and operate them — including the certificate authority — an offer no card maker on this list delivers on the channel side today.

Competitive Positioning

Card-maker peers cluster on hardware alone. HID is the lone incumbent with the full wrap — the partnership is how CardLogix joins it.

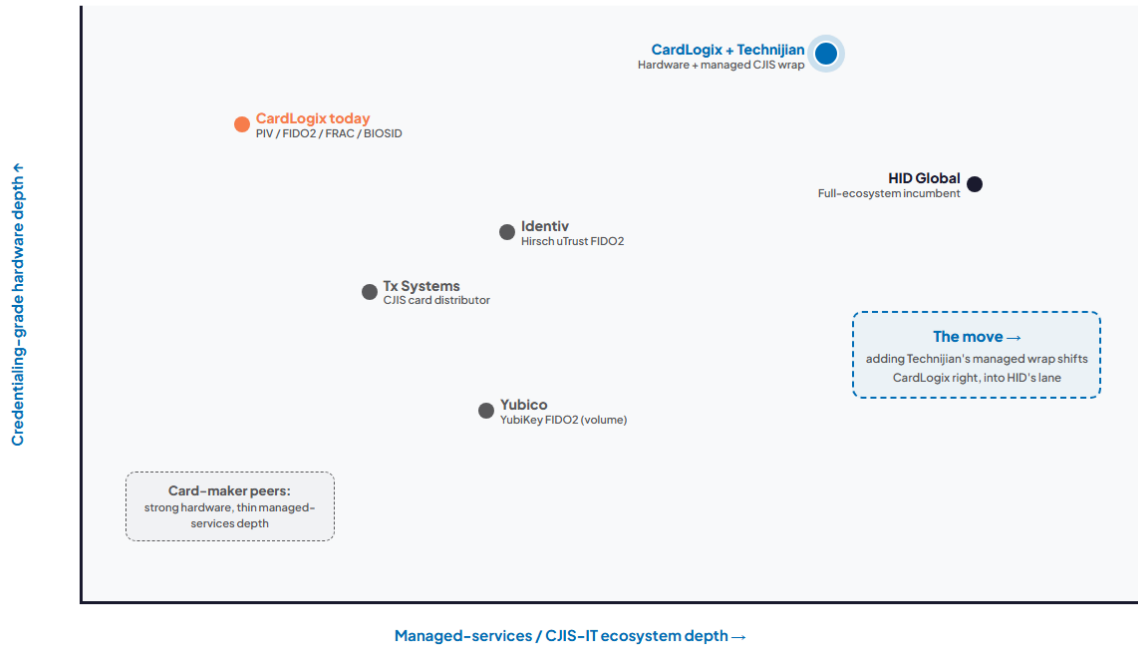


Figure 5.0 — Positioning: credentialing-grade hardware depth vs. managed-services / CJIS-IT ecosystem depth

The White Space

No card maker in CardLogix's peer set delivers the managed-IT, security-operations, and CJIS-compliance wrap on the channel side. That is open ground.

CardLogix already owns the hard part — NIST-certified, GSA-approved, credentialing-grade hardware with 28 years behind it. The missing piece is operational delivery, not product.

A partnership claims that white space first: "buy the card, and the environment it lives in is already handled." It is the answer to the one objection that sends deals to HID.

06 Technijian Capability Proof

Before any pitch, one thing should be clear: Technijian has already built the operational pieces both tracks require. The capabilities below are delivered and operating — not proposals. Each maps to a specific CardLogix use case. Where a capability is adjacent rather than built (CJIS), this section says so plainly.

Proven Build 1 — Co-Managed IT for Lean Internal Teams (My IT)

What Technijian Built: Technijian runs a co-managed model that extends a client's internal IT: after-hours and overflow help desk, shared monitoring, ticketing and documentation, senior architects on demand, and shared security and compliance ownership.

How This Applies to CardLogix: This is Track A, directly. It fits a shop where one capable person runs IT and needs coverage and senior depth without giving up control — exactly CardLogix's current internal situation.

Proven Build 2 — Managed Security Operations (My Security)

What Technijian Built: Technijian operates a 24/7 security program — monitoring and response, endpoint detection, SIEM, MFA-everywhere, and conditional access — built on Microsoft Entra ID and Microsoft Defender.

How This Applies to CardLogix: This is the security half of the CJIS wrap. The same controls an agency needs for the CJIS Security Policy — access control, logging, incident response — are the ones Technijian already runs for other regulated clients.

Proven Build 3 — Multi-Framework Compliance Practice (My Compliance)

What Technijian Built: Technijian delivers managed compliance across eight frameworks, including CMMC/DFARS for defense-adjacent clients — control mapping, evidence collection, and audit readiness as an ongoing service.

How This Applies to CardLogix: CMMC is the closest neighbor to CJIS: shared control families, the same evidence discipline, the same audit posture. The CJIS practice is a near-term extension of this proven model — built for the partnership, not claimed as existing.

Proven Build 4 — AI Document Intelligence (RFPs and Evidence: days to minutes)

What Technijian Built: Technijian built an AI document-intelligence capability that turns proposal- and evidence-heavy work from days into minutes, with model peer-review to keep output accurate.

How This Applies to CardLogix: On Track B this becomes AI-assisted CJIS audit-evidence packs and faster grant- and RFP-response drafting for joint agency deals — the paperwork that otherwise slows a small agency's compliance to a crawl.

Proven Build 5 — My AI Lead Gen: Account-Based Intelligence

What Technijian Built: My AI Lead Gen is Technijian's account-based engine — it builds target lists from public data, enriches and scores them, and produces per-account dossiers and personalized outreach, replacing the data-subscription tax.

How This Applies to CardLogix: For the partnership it identifies and profiles named agencies (by region, size, and CJIS-deadline exposure) and the integrators that serve them — turning CardLogix's channel into a targeted, intelligence-led motion rather than a broad campaign.

Representative Engagements — Work Like Yours

Capability statements matter less than what we actually do for companies your size. Two recent engagements map closely to CardLogix's own environment — a lean team, an on-prem footprint, the identity-and-server modernization that sits underneath Track A. They are described by scope and effort and fully anonymized; we are glad to arrange a reference conversation at the right stage.

Engagement — On-Prem Active Directory → Microsoft Entra ID (21-user firm)

What Technijian Built: A four-phase migration for a 21-desktop business off aging on-premise Active Directory to cloud identity (Microsoft Entra ID): evaluation of the existing AD, a tailored cloud-identity design (roles, policies, access levels), automated migration of all user accounts and profiles to minimize downtime, and safe decommissioning of the old domain controller. Scoped at ~50 hours.

How This Applies to CardLogix: This is the exact identity foundation the MFA conversation rests on — the same Entra ID layer your certificate-based and FIDO2 authentication plugs into. A close analog to standing up a clean, cloud-anchored identity base before layering phishing-resistant credentials on top.

Engagement — Server 2012→2022 + Hyper-V→ESXi Modernization (2-host)

What Technijian Built: A staged modernization of a two-host virtualization environment: assessment and migration plan, an on-site loaner ESXi server to build and migrate onto with zero data loss, host-by-host upgrade (HV01 then HV02) with VMs live-migrated across the pair, then load-balancing and removal of the loaner. Scoped at ~84 hours, sequenced so the business kept running throughout.

How This Applies to CardLogix: CardLogix runs roughly this shape — about two servers carrying the load. It shows the disciplined, no-downtime way Technijian modernizes a small server footprint, which is precisely the work the co-managed engagement (Track A) absorbs.

How We Keep AI Affordable — Seven Models, Routed by Task

A fair question about running AI across authority content, account intelligence, and compliance evidence: won't the token bill be enormous? Not the way Technijian builds it. We do not wire every task to one expensive model — our platform routes across roughly seven models, spanning three AI vendors and three capability tiers, and sends each sub-task to the cheapest model that can do it well.

Tier	What It Does	Share of Work
Frontier (premium)	The hardest judgment only — final brand-voice pass, compliance-critical answers, the deepest reasoning	~5–10%
Workhorse (balanced)	The bulk of drafting and reasoning — content, outreach personalization, summarization, account scoring	~30–40%
Lightweight (low-cost)	High-volume mechanical work — classification, extraction, enriching and tagging thousands of agency and integrator records	~50–60%

The result: CardLogix pays premium-model prices only for the small slice of work that warrants them — typically a 60–80% lower run cost than routing everything to one top-tier model, with no quality loss where it counts. A single piece of CJIS-authority content is drafted by a low-cost model, tightened and fact-checked by a mid model, and given a final brand-and-accuracy pass by a frontier model — instead of one premium model doing all three at roughly triple the cost. That is the kind of AI-engineering depth a partner brings that wiring everything to one chatbot does not.

07 Understanding AI — A Field Guide for CardLogix Leadership

This section exists to make the rest of this report easy to evaluate. No jargon, no hype — just what AI is, where CardLogix sits today, how to adopt it without risk, and what comparable organizations are already doing. The goal is that Nick, and in turn Sebastien and Tom, can judge every recommendation that follows on its merits.

What AI Actually Is — and Isn't

As MIT Sloan puts it, a leader needs to know what AI can and cannot do — not how to build it. In practice, the only distinction that matters for planning is this:

- Automation (workflows): the AI follows a path you define — predictable and low-risk. For example, "draft this CJIS audit-evidence pack from these control records." This is where almost all near-term value lives.
- Agents: the AI decides the steps itself — more flexible, and it needs human oversight. For example, "watch named agency grant cycles and flag what needs outreach." This comes later, where it earns its place.

The operating principle (Anthropic's guidance on building AI systems) is to use the simplest thing that works. CardLogix starts with simple automations that pay off in the first 90 days, and adds autonomous agents only where the value is proven — which is exactly how the roadmap in this report is sequenced.

Where CardLogix Sits Today — The AI Maturity Ladder

Most established, well-run companies — including CardLogix — sit at the first or second rung of a widely-used five-stage AI maturity model (consistent with Gartner and Google Cloud frameworks). The leaders in any field are only one or two rungs higher, and the gap closes in months, not years.

Stage	What It Looks Like	CardLogix Today
1. Foundational	Little or no AI; manual, people-dependent processes	
2. Emerging	Real digital products and content exist (the website, the CJIS/MFA blog), but AI is not yet woven into growth or operations	◀ You are here
3. Operational	AI runs specific workflows day-to-day — authority content, account intelligence, compliance evidence — with measured results	
4. Scaled	AI is embedded across growth and operations with governance and dashboards	
5. Transformational	AI is the default way the business runs and competes	

CardLogix already produces real authority content and runs a credentialing-grade product line, which puts it at the Emerging stage. This report is the plan to reach Operational — AI working in the growth engine and inside the compliance and account-intelligence workflows — within twelve months.

Adopting AI Responsibly — Three Risks Every Leader Manages

The U.S. government’s NIST AI Risk Management Framework gives leaders a simple mental model — Govern, Map, Measure, Manage. For a security-and-compliance company like CardLogix, three risks matter most, and each has a concrete control:

Risk	What It Means	How Technijian Controls It
Hallucination	AI can state a confident, wrong answer	Human-in-the-loop review on anything customer-facing or compliance-bound — AI drafts, a person approves
Data leakage	Sensitive data pasted into public tools can escape	Private, governed AI deployments — CJIS-bound records, agency data, and certificate material never touch a public model

Risk	What It Means	How Technijian Controls It
Compliance & accountability	Untracked AI tools create audit gaps	Every AI tool inventoried with owner, vendor, and data source — CJIS/CMMC-ready, led by a CISSP-certified team

What Comparable Organizations Are Already Doing

- Security hardware makers: credential and identity vendors are using AI-search optimization to become the cited answer when an agency IT lead asks an AI tool "how do we meet CJIS MFA?" — capturing demand competitors never see.
- Regulated B2B: document-heavy regulated businesses are turning multi-day proposal and compliance-evidence assembly into a minutes-long, audit-ready draft — responding to more agency RFPs and grants with the same team.
- Channel sellers: companies that sell through integrators are using account intelligence on named targets — region, size, regulatory-deadline exposure — to point a finite sales team at the accounts most ready to buy.

These are representative directions of travel across comparable industries, not guarantees; CardLogix's own numbers would be confirmed in discovery. Technijian's specific, measured results from prior builds appear in Section 06 (Capability Proof) and the Business-Impact section.

A Day in the Life — Nick, Running IT and Business Development

Before vs. After AI

TODAY: Nick runs IT solo for a growing shop — fielding after-hours issues, patching by hand, provisioning users, and being the second pair of eyes on anything unusual — then switches hats to business development, researching agencies and integrators and drafting outreach and RFP responses one at a time, mostly from knowledge held in his own head.

WITH AI: Co-managed IT absorbs the toil — monitoring, patching, after-hours coverage handled by a partner pod, with Nick keeping strategic control. On the growth side, an AI account-intelligence engine surfaces the named agencies most ready to buy and drafts the per-account outreach, while an AI document-intelligence layer turns RFP and CJIS-evidence drafting from days into minutes. Nick reviews and approves; the expertise is captured in a system instead of living only in his head.

Why a Partner — vs. Hiring or Doing It Yourself

Path	Reality
DIY tools	Inexpensive, but CardLogix assembles, secures, and governs everything — and owns the three risks above alone
Hire in-house	A capable AI leader typically costs \$180K+/year and is scarce, and one person cannot cover strategy, build, security, and governance
Partner (Technijian)	Strategy, build, security, and governance in one team at a fraction of a hire — with proven builds and CISSP-led security

Sources cited in this section: MIT Sloan Management (AI literacy); Anthropic (AI system design); a widely-used five-stage AI maturity model (consistent with Gartner and Google Cloud frameworks); U.S. NIST AI Risk Management Framework. Full references in the Appendix.

08 The AI Growth Engine

The engine runs three motions, and because this is an account-based opportunity, every motion is aimed at named buyers rather than a broad funnel. AI sits underneath the human relationship layer — it surfaces the right agencies, arms the conversation, and automates the evidence — but the trust between CardLogix, Technijian, and an agency is still what closes a deal. Stating that plainly is the point.

This is not theoretical for us. Our own My AI Lead Gen engine — the same account-intelligence approach proposed here — runs on public-data pipelines that have cut prospecting effort by roughly 80% and brought cost-per-qualified-lead under \$3, a 3–5× pipeline-velocity gain over manual research. We would point that engine at the named-agency universe CardLogix sells into.

CardLogix AI Growth Engine

Account-based (ABM): AI sits *under* the named-account strategy — it does not replace the relationship layer.

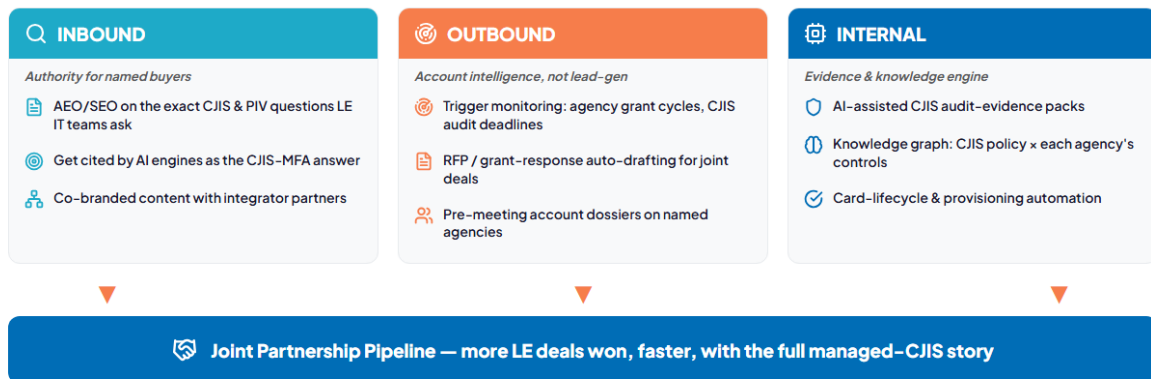


Figure 7.0 — The Engine: Inbound authority, Outbound account intelligence, Internal evidence — feeding one joint pipeline

Motion	Play	What It Does	Metric	Service
Inbound	Authority / AEO content	Answer the exact CJIS, PIV, and FIDO2 questions agency IT teams ask — so the partnership is the cited expert	AI-answer citations	My SEO
Inbound	Co-branded content	Joint material with integrators that lifts the whole channel	Channel-sourced inquiries	My SEO
Outbound	Account intelligence	Identify and profile named agencies by region, size, CJIS exposure	Qualified accounts	My AI Lead Gen
Outbound	Trigger monitoring	Watch grant cycles, audit deadlines, leadership changes on named targets	Timed outreach events	My AI
Outbound	RFP / grant drafting	Auto-draft responses for joint agency opportunities	Time-to-response	My AI
Internal	CJIS evidence packs	AI-assisted audit evidence and control mapping	Audit-prep hours saved	My Compliance
Internal	Knowledge graph	CJIS policy mapped against each agency's controls	Reusable control maps	My AI
Internal	Card-lifecycle automation	Provisioning, binding, and renewal workflow around issuance	Issuance cycle time	My Dev

AI Search Reality Check

Here is the inbound gap made concrete. When an agency IT lead asks an AI assistant the question below today, this is the shape of the answer they get — illustrative of how AI search resolves this query right now:

Prompt: "Who can deploy and run CJIS-compliant phishing-resistant MFA for a small police department?"

TODAY — the AI assistant answers with whichever vendors have the strongest content and third-party signals it can read: it names the large identity incumbents and a couple of MFA platforms, and does NOT surface a CardLogix + managed-services-partner answer — even though that joint offer is the more complete one for an agency that lacks internal IT. The partnership is invisible at the exact moment the agency is forming a shortlist.

AFTER AEO/AUTHORITY CONTENT — the same query can return the joint offer as a cited option ("CardLogix supplies the phishing-resistant credentials; a managed-services partner stands up and runs the CJIS-aligned environment around them, including the certificate authority..."), with the authority content and FAQ pages as the supporting evidence the assistant points to.

(Illustrative of current AI-search behavior for this query class — not a screenshot; the live result is part of the free Nexus Assess baseline.)

The Honest Boundary

Inbound authority content and internal evidence automation are highly automatable — AI does most of that work, and it compounds over time.

Outbound account intelligence makes the human outreach sharper and better-timed, but the relationship with each agency — and the executive relationship between CardLogix and Technijian — is what signs the deal.

The plan is built to be truthful about that line. AI multiplies a small team's reach and removes the paperwork drag; it does not pretend software wins an agency contract on its own.

09 Business Impact & Service Investment

The pricing below is built land-and-expand: a small, easy-to-approve entry that solves a real problem now (Track A), and a clearly-labeled later expansion that builds the partnership engine once the working relationship is proven (Track B). The managed-IT and labor figures are drawn from Technijian's current 2026 rate card — real published rates, not round-number guesses — and are calibrated to a firm quote after the free assessment. The figures most sensitive to your environment are CardLogix's actual endpoint count and the number it walked from on the prior co-managed conversation; the discovery questions in Section 13 pin those down.

The Managed Certificate Authority — the Technical Anchor

In our conversation Nick asked specifically what Technijian recommends for the certificate authority (CA) behind the credentials — the system that issues and signs them. This is the technical heart of the partnership offer, and Technijian has already done the engineering work on it. The short version: rather than keep the CA key in software on a Windows server (where a breach exposes it), the CA key is generated inside a dedicated, FIPS-validated cloud Hardware Security Module (HSM) and designed to be non-exportable — it stays in tamper-resistant hardware rather than living on a server an attacker can copy. Because the existing key may already be exposed, the right move is to stand up a fresh CA in the HSM rather than migrate the old one. Indicative cost runs roughly \$2,000–\$4,000/mo for the HSM-backed CA infrastructure depending on cloud and redundancy (detailed, with the AWS-vs-Azure recommendation, in the companion CloudHSM analysis); on the partnership model CardLogix resells it and Technijian operates it.

Technijian has prepared a companion deliverable — the CardLogix Managed-PKI / Cloud HSM analysis — that compares AWS CloudHSM and Microsoft Azure Cloud HSM on cost, fit, and implementation, with a working commercial model where CardLogix resells the service and Technijian implements and operates it. That document holds the cost tables and step-by-step build; it is kept separate from this strategy on purpose, because its provider pricing is list-price-current and will be validated at quote time. For this blueprint, the point is simpler:

the managed CA is a real, costed, deliverable service that becomes the technical anchor of the Track-B expansion — offered per customer on AWS, Azure, or Google to match whichever cloud they already run.

The Entry Offer — The 90-Day AI Visibility Pilot (Track A)

Start with one clearly-scoped, fixed-price program — not an open-ended engagement. The pilot stands up CardLogix's co-managed IT coverage and the authority-content foundation the partnership's inbound presence rests on, and proves the working rhythm before any larger build is discussed.

Service	Scope	Est. Monthly	Est. Y1
My IT — Co-Managed	Managed-services stack (endpoint security, patching, monitoring, image backup) for ~6 workstations + 2 servers, plus a monthly block of co-managed senior support — billed per Technijian's 2026 managed-services schedule. Ad-hoc / project work beyond the block at the labor rates below.	~\$1,200	~\$14,400
My SEO — Tier 3 (authority content)†	GEO/authority content on the MFA, CJIS, and smart-card questions buyers ask; foundation for the partnership's inbound presence	\$1,000	\$12,000
My AI — Readiness Workshop	One-time executive workshop (CTO-advisory hours) to map the joint go-to-market and the CJIS-practice build path	—	~\$5,000
THE 90-DAY AI VISIBILITY PILOT (Y1)	The land — solves Track A now, fixed scope, no large build		~\$31,400

† The managed-IT figure is grounded in Technijian's current 2026 managed-services schedule and is consistent with what comparable lean offices pay today. The SEO line is My SEO Tier 3 at its standard \$1,000/mo published rate — kept lean on purpose for the entry; the fuller program that adds AI Search Optimization, PR, and content syndication runs \$1,550/mo and can layer on later. All figures are confirmed in a firm quote after the free assessment.

On the Cost Concern From Last Time

CardLogix looked at co-managed support before and stepped back on cost — so this entry is built specifically to answer that. It is priced per-endpoint, not as an enterprise retainer; there is no large up-front build; and routine work runs on the blended US-led model that keeps the monthly low.

It is month-to-month-friendly and the free assessment comes first — so you see the real scope and a firm number before committing to anything. The goal is an easy yes, not a leap of faith.

The Pilot Bar — and Our Commitment

Success metric: within 90 days, CardLogix has co-managed IT live and stable across its environment AND a published authority-content foundation answering the core CJIS / MFA / smart-card questions — with at least one piece beginning to surface in AI-assisted search for those queries.

Our commitment: the entry program is month-to-month, no lock-in. If the pilot has not hit that metric by day 90, you are under no obligation to continue, and we will tell you honestly whether it is worth continuing. You carry the upside, not the risk.

Labor Rates — 2026 Rate Card (for ad-hoc & project work)

So there are no surprises, here are Technijian's standard 2026 labor rates. Anything beyond the co-managed support block — projects, after-hours incidents, the CA/HSM build — is billed at these published rates, and the offshore and contracted columns are how a co-managed relationship keeps cost down.

Role	Normal hrs*	After-hours*	Contracted**
US Tech Support / Engineering	\$150/hr	\$250/hr	\$125/hr
CTO / vCIO Advisory	\$250/hr	\$350/hr	\$225/hr
Developer (US)	\$150/hr	—	\$125/hr
Blended delivery (US-led, global team)‡	included in plan	included in plan	lowest effective rate

* Normal hours are Mon–Fri 7:00 AM–7:00 PM PT; after-hours is all other times. ** Contracted = discounted rate on a 3-, 6-, or 12-month cycle commitment. ‡ Routine, repeatable work (monitoring, patching, provisioning, content production) is delivered through Technijian's blended US-led global model — senior US architects direct and own the relationship while a follow-the-sun team handles execution, which is what lets a co-managed plan stay well below the à-la-carte rates above. Any work touching CJIS or other regulated data is performed by US-based, background-screened personnel. On-site has a 2-hour minimum with no trip charges; emergency/critical response is billed at the after-hours rate with a 1-hour minimum.

The Expansion — Track B (once the entry proves out)

Service	Scope	Est. Monthly	Est. Y1
My Cloud + My Security — Managed CA on Cloud HSM (Phase 2)	The HSM-backed certificate authority Nick asked us to recommend: a fresh CA key generated inside a CA-grade cloud HSM (AWS / Azure / Google, per the customer), not migrated from the existing software CA. Detailed in the companion CloudHSM analysis.	per customer	resold + managed
My Compliance — CJIS Practice Build (Phase 2)	Formalize a CJIS wrapper on the existing CMMC foundation: control mapping, evidence model, audit posture	—	~\$25,000–40,000
My AI — Account-Intelligence Engine (Phase 2)	Fractional AI advisor + the named-account intelligence, trigger monitoring, and RFP engine	~\$2,000	~\$24,000
My Security — Managed SOC for Pilot (Phase 2)	The 24/7 security operations behind the first joint customer pilot	scoped	per pilot
My Dev — Card-Lifecycle Automation (Phase 2)	Provisioning, identity-binding, and renewal workflow around card issuance	—	scoped build
FULL ENGINE (entry + expansion)	The partnership engine — built after Track A proves the rhythm		scoped at pilot

How the Partnership Splits — An Opening Position

A channel partnership is its economics, so here is a strawman to react to — explicitly an opening position, fully negotiable, and exactly the kind of thing to settle with Sebastien and Tom. The principle: CardLogix owns the credential and the customer relationship; Technijian delivers and operates the managed environment; each side is paid for what it brings, and neither carries the other's risk.

Element	CardLogix	Technijian
Sells / owns the account	Yes — your brand, your customer, your card	Behind the scenes or co-branded, your call
Hardware revenue	100% to CardLogix	None — we never touch card margin
Managed-services revenue	Referral: up to 10% of the gross monthly service invoice — or your own markup on resale	Balance, for delivering + operating
Who carries delivery liability	None for the managed wrap	Technijian owns the SLA and the ops risk
Two clean models to choose from	Referral: you refer, we contract + pay you up to 10% of the gross monthly service invoice	Resale: you contract, we wholesale to you, you set retail

Either model bounds CardLogix's exposure to essentially zero on the delivery side while creating a new recurring margin stream on hardware you already sell. Which model fits — and your resale markup, if you take that route — is a 30-minute conversation, not a prerequisite to starting.

Year-1 ROI — A Range, Modeled Against the Entry

Start with the expected case: about 1.8× in Year 1 — the co-managed IT line pays for itself on recovered time alone, and a single partnership win clears the rest. The full range below sets expectations honestly, not on a single optimistic number, and none of the cases count the full revenue the expansion adds — so even the Likely case understates the real opportunity. The model separates the two halves of the entry honestly: the co-managed IT line is a cost-recovery play (it pays for itself in recovered staff time), while the SEO/authority foundation and readiness workshop are growth investments whose return arrives through partnership

wins. Read the columns this way: the Very Conservative floor assumes zero partnership wins in Year 1; the Likely case counts a single joint managed-MFA/CA win, which Nick has confirmed is a service CardLogix wants to offer; the Upside reflects the broader private-sector, insurance-driven demand gaining traction sooner.

Model Input	Downside-Protected (zero wins)	Likely (expected)	Upside
Internal IT hours recovered (Y1)*	~150 hrs	~250 hrs	~350 hrs
Value of that recovered capacity**	+\$15,000	+\$25,000	+\$35,000
Co-managed IT line (~\$14,400/yr) — payback on recovered time alone	≈ pays for itself	≈ 1.7×	≈ 2.4×
Joint managed-MFA / CA customer wins (Y1)	0	1	2
Recurring value per joint win***	—	+\$30,000	+\$30,000
Total estimated Y1 value (all sources)	+\$15,000	+\$55,000	+\$95,000
Full entry program (Y1)†	~\$31,400	~\$31,400	~\$31,400
Net Y1 position	IT pays for itself; growth spend not yet returned	~1.8×	~3.0×

* Recovered hours = time spent on after-hours, patching, and provisioning that co-managed IT absorbs. ** Valued at a conservative blended internal rate (~\$100/hr). *** Derivation of the ~\$30,000/win: a single mid-size LE agency or private firm adopting the managed credential environment is modeled at roughly \$2,000–\$3,000/mo of recurring managed-services value to the partnership (managed IT + SOC + the CA wrap, ~25–50 seats) — i.e. ~\$24,000–\$36,000/yr; we use \$30,000 as the midpoint. It is an estimate, ranged at discovery against a real pilot, not a promise. † The full entry program (~\$31,400) includes the co-managed IT line plus growth investments (authority/SEO foundation + readiness workshop) whose return shows up through partnership wins, not through recovered IT hours — which is why the floor is measured on the IT line, not on the full program. All figures are estimates pending discovery.

How to Read This Range

The floor is deliberately cautious: it assumes the partnership lands nothing in Year 1. Even then, the co-managed IT line pays for itself in recovered time alone, and the entry still buys a compounding authority/SEO asset and a mapped go-to-market — value the floor does not dollar-count. We show the zero-win case on purpose so the downside is honest.

The Likely case (~1.8×) is our realistic expectation — it counts a single joint managed-MFA/CA customer win, the kind of service Nick indicated CardLogix wants to offer. One win clears the entry cost and then some.

The real economics sit above this table. Every figure is measured against the small entry only; the expansion — the managed CA on cloud HSM, the CJIS practice, the account-intelligence engine — scales the partnership against a market now widening from federal and law-enforcement into private companies driven by cyber-insurance. Discovery replaces these estimates with CardLogix's real endpoint count, the prior co-managed benchmark, and a concrete pilot target.

The Bigger Picture — One Partner vs. a Stack of Vendors

It is worth zooming out from any single line item. The capabilities in this plan — managed IT, security operations, compliance, marketing and authority content, sales intelligence, AI integration, and custom development — are things most companies buy from six or eight separate vendors, each with its own contract, renewal, onboarding, and account-management overhead. The table below is what that fragmented stack costs a firm of CardLogix's size at typical 2025–2026 market rates. It is not a set of competitor quotes; it is the published market reality for each category, leaning conservative on purpose.

What you would otherwise assemble (separate vendors)	Typical market cost / mo
Managed / Co-Managed IT	\$2,000 – \$4,000
24/7 Cybersecurity (SOC / MDR / EDR)	\$400 – \$1,000
Compliance program + vCISO	\$1,500 – \$5,000
Digital marketing agency (SEO / content / PPC mgmt)*	\$3,000 – \$8,000
Sales intelligence / lead data (ZoomInfo, Apollo)	\$150 – \$2,500

What you would otherwise assemble (separate vendors)	Typical market cost / mo
AI advisory / integration	\$2,500 – \$5,000
Custom app / managed-app dev capacity	\$500 – \$3,000
vCIO / IT strategy (incremental)**	\$1,000 – \$3,000
Fragmented multi-vendor reality (a typical working subset)	~\$6,000 – \$12,000 / mo
Technijian entry program (Track A — your starting point)	~\$2,600 / mo
Full consolidated program (entry + expansion)	scoped after a free Nexus Assess

* Excludes the ad media spend itself. ** Comprehensive managed-IT plans often bundle light vCIO, so this is shown as an incremental line only. Figures are market-typical ranges drawn from published 2025–2026 pricing data — not competitor quotes — and vary by size, scope, and contract term. Summed in full these categories run higher; the ~\$6,000–\$12,000/mo composite reflects the core stack a firm this size actually runs (managed IT + security + light compliance + a modest content retainer), with ad spend, software licenses, and one-time build capex excluded. The ~\$2,600/mo entry program is the Track-A starting point — not yet the full stack — so it is not an apples-to-apples replacement for every line above; the point is the direction, that consolidating onto one partner begins well below the fragmented total and scales efficiently from there. Your firm quote is set after the free Nexus Assess.

Why One Partner Costs Less — Honestly

Consolidation itself is the first saving: one relationship, one bill, one accountable team instead of six to eight vendors to coordinate — each charging its own onboarding and account-management tax, and several (managed-detection especially) carrying per-seat minimums that make a firm this size pay a premium just to clear their floor.

The structural cost advantage is real and specific: Technijian runs a US-senior + India-blended delivery model. Most of the stack above is priced on labor — vCISO hours, agency hours, AI-advisory hours, dev hours, IT-strategy time. Independent rate data puts US onshore work at roughly \$100–\$200/hr versus a blended \$50–\$100/hr; Technijian keeps senior US architects on the work that needs them and runs the rest through the India delivery center, so the same outcomes come from a structurally lower cost base — not a discount that erodes service.

We do not put a Technijian “total” on this page on purpose. The honest number comes from a scoped quote after the free Nexus Assess — but whatever lines CardLogix actually needs, consolidating them with one partner on a blended-delivery model lands well under assembling them vendor by vendor.

10 Implementation Roadmap

The roadmap sequences the two tracks: land Track A fast, prove the joint motion on a single pilot, then scale the channel play. It is paced for a lean organization — no phase asks CardLogix to absorb more than it comfortably can while still running its business.

Implementation Roadmap

Land Track A first; prove the joint motion on one pilot; then scale the channel play.

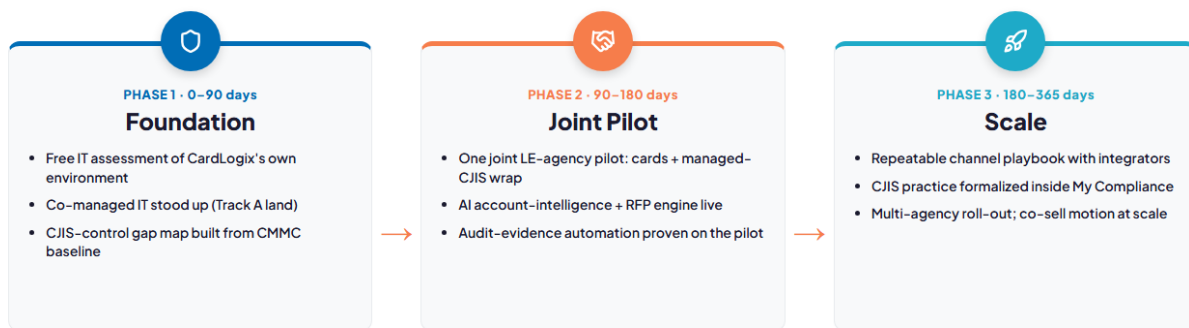


Figure 9.0 — Foundation (0–90 days) → Joint Pilot (90–180) → Scale (180–365)

Phase 1 — Foundation (0–90 days)

- Free IT assessment of CardLogix's own environment — endpoints, servers, backup, identity posture.
- Stand up the co-managed IT engagement (Track A): coverage, monitoring, and senior support in place.
- Build the CJIS-control gap map from the existing CMMC baseline — the blueprint for the practice build.

Phase 2 — Joint Pilot (90–180 days)

- Run one joint pilot with a single LE agency: CardLogix cards plus Technijian's managed, CJIS-aligned wrap.
- Bring the AI account-intelligence and RFP engine live against named target agencies.

- ☐ Prove the audit-evidence automation on the pilot — the reusable proof point for every deal after.

Phase 3 — Scale (180–365 days)

- ☐ Turn the pilot into a repeatable channel playbook with CardLogix's integrators.
- ☐ Formalize the CJIS practice inside My Compliance as a standing capability.
- ☐ Move to a co-sell motion across multiple agencies — the partnership operating at scale.

11 Quick Wins — No Commitment Required

A handful of things CardLogix can do right away with no contract and no spend — each a genuine improvement on its own, and each a natural on-ramp to the program. The first is the marquee: a complete, no-cost security and risk assessment.

Run a free Nexus Assess security assessment

Nexus Assess is Technijian's one-time, point-in-time IT risk and security assessment. We run it once at no charge so CardLogix gets a real, evidence-backed picture of where it stands today — internally, on the perimeter, and across Microsoft 365 — delivered as a prioritized remediation roadmap that reads like a board memo, not a raw vulnerability dump. It draws on 20+ underlying security tools, dual risk scoring (a proprietary score plus CVSS and Microsoft Secure Score), and a library of 100+ report types. Three layers matter most here:

- **Internal vulnerability assessment.** Non-intrusive discovery across Windows, macOS, and Linux; full device inventory; Active Directory and Azure AD security review (users, group policy, stale accounts, privilege sprawl); missing security patches and end-of-life / unsupported operating systems; AV/EDR coverage gaps; local and domain password-policy review; insecure listening ports and services; even SQL Server database security — all rolled into an overall risk score with each issue ranked by severity.
- **External vulnerability assessment.** A scan of CardLogix's public-facing surface — exposed ports and services, weak or expired SSL/TLS certificates, and domain/DNS hygiene an attacker would probe first — plus dark-web monitoring and credential-exposure detection for company logins already leaked in known breaches.
- **Microsoft 365 assessment.** A full tenant security review across M365, Teams, SharePoint, OneDrive, and Exchange: MFA coverage for every user, risky or suspicious sign-ins, mailbox forwarding and inbox rules (a common breach indicator), admin-role assignments, external sharing and guest-access settings, and license waste — exactly the surface that matters when the whole strategy turns on phishing-resistant identity.

Because Nexus Assess also maps findings to HIPAA, SOC 2, PCI-DSS, CJIS, and NIST CSF, the same free run doubles as a head start on the CJIS-control gap map that Track B will need.

And four more, no commitment

- **Inventory the two servers.** Document what runs on each (roles, OS version, backup state). It is the first thing any scoping needs — and Nexus Assess above captures most of it automatically.
- **Map the MFA / CJIS exposure in the channel.** List the agency-facing integrators already selling CardLogix cards — the seed list for any joint motion.
- **Pull the prior co-managed proposal.** Revisit the number CardLogix walked from and why; it frames a fair, right-sized scope this time.
- **Review one published CJIS / MFA FAQ.** See how few card makers answer agency CJIS and MFA questions well online — the authority gap is visible in minutes.

12 Questions We Usually Get

The honest answers to the questions CardLogix leadership is most likely asking right now.

Question	Our Honest Answer
Nick already runs our IT. Why add Technijian?	Nick keeps strategic control — co-managed IT extends his reach, it does not replace him. We absorb the toil (after-hours coverage, patching, monitoring, second-pair-of-eyes on incidents) and bring senior depth on demand, so a growing shop is not one person away from a problem. The entry is sized to a lean team on purpose.
Isn't AI mostly hype right now?	A lot of it is. That is why this blueprint starts with simple, proven automations that pay back fast — account intelligence on named agencies and AI-assisted evidence drafting — not autonomous "agents" running your business. We use the simplest tool that works, measure it, and only expand what earns its place.
Is our data — agency records, CJIS-bound material, certificate keys — safe?	Yes. Sensitive data never touches a public AI model; we deploy private, governed systems with human review on anything compliance-bound, led by a CISSP-certified team. The certificate authority is designed around a FIPS-validated, non-exportable key in a cloud HSM, and any CJI-touching work is handled by US-based, background-screened staff.
We're a lean team. Do we have the bandwidth to add a vendor?	The point is the opposite — to give Nick back hours, not add work. Technijian runs the build and the cadence; your involvement is a short monthly check-in plus reviewing what we draft. Track B (the partnership) stays a separate, later conversation so it never crowds the easy first step.
What if it doesn't work?	The entry starts with a free Nexus Assess and a month-to-month-friendly co-managed engagement — no large up-front build and no long lock-in. You see the real scope and a firm number before committing, and if it is not delivering we will tell you honestly. You carry the upside, not the risk.

Question	Our Honest Answer
What does it really cost?	The entry program is approximately \$31K for Year 1 at published 2026 rates — no hidden fees, no large up-front build. The partnership expansion (the managed CA, the CJIS practice, the account-intelligence engine) is profiled in Section 09, but only after the entry proves the rhythm and Goulet/Hope are ready.

13 Next Steps & Discovery

These follow directly from what we agreed on the May 29 call: Technijian delivers this AI growth strategy, follows with the managed certificate-authority / cloud-HSM options, and Nick sends over the other IT issues on his list. The steps below put structure around that.

1. The one easy yes — book the free Nexus Assess. At no cost and no obligation, Technijian walks the environment and hands back a board-ready risk map plus a scoped, right-sized co-managed (Track A) option with a firm number. This is the only decision in front of CardLogix today, and nothing past the assessment is committed.
2. Send the other IT issues on your list so the assessment is scoped against real priorities.
3. Keep Track B separate and later. The partnership (managed-MFA / CA) needs Goulet and Hope, so it stays a parallel conversation — not part of the easy yes. Technijian has prepared a one-page Partnership Concept Brief (the companion document) for Nick to forward when the timing is right; nothing in the Track A step commits CardLogix to it.
4. Already in hand: this strategy plus the companion CloudHSM analysis on the managed-CA options Nick asked about — including the recommendation to generate a fresh CA key inside a CA-grade cloud HSM rather than migrate the existing software CA.

Discovery Questions (to replace every estimate with a real number)

- ☐ How many users and endpoints today, and where does the next 12 months take that?
- ☐ What runs on the two servers — file, AD, application, virtualization? On-prem AD or hybrid? Backup posture?
- ☐ What eats the most internal IT time right now — after-hours, patching, provisioning, security alerts?
- ☐ What did the prior co-managed conversation look like — what number and what model?

- ☐ Who owns a partnership decision internally, and what would make Goulet or Hope take the meeting?
- ☐ What does a typical agency end-customer look like, and how do they end up with a CardLogix card today?

Your next step: book the free Nexus Assess.

At no cost and no obligation, you get a board-ready map of exactly where
CardLogix stands —

internal, external, and Microsoft 365 — plus the scoped, firm Track A number.
Month-to-month — the easy yes, not a lock-in.

Book with Ravi Jain | RJain@technijian.com | 949.379.8499 | technijian.com

14 About Technijian

Technijian is an AI-native managed services and technology firm headquartered in Irvine, California — minutes from CardLogix in the Spectrum — serving small and mid-sized businesses since 2000. We design, build, and operate secure infrastructure with security and compliance built in, and a dedicated team assigned to each client.

**Since
2000**

26 years in continuous
operation

1,000+

networks served

24/7

SOC — 15-minute
critical-response SLA

CrowdStrike

powered cybersecurity

Working With Us Is Low-Risk by Design

A dedicated pod that knows your environment; 24/7 coverage from the USA + India with a 15-minute critical-response SLA; CrowdStrike-powered security and managed compliance across eight frameworks (HIPAA, SOC 2, PCI, CMMC, GDPR, NIST CSF, CIS, ISO 27001).

Month-to-month-friendly terms, your data stays yours, and every engagement starts with a free assessment — so you prove the fit before you commit. For any CJIS-bound or regulated work, delivery is handled by US-based, background-screened personnel.

Service	Role in This Blueprint
My IT	Co-managed IT for CardLogix's internal team (Track A) and the managed-IT half of the agency wrap (Track B)
My Security	24/7 security operations — the SOC, EDR, MFA, and access control behind a CJIS-aligned environment
My Compliance	Eight frameworks today, with CJIS as the near-term build adjacent to the existing CMMC practice
My AI	Account intelligence, trigger monitoring, evidence automation, and the readiness workshop

Service	Role in This Blueprint
My SEO	Authority and AEO content aimed at the specific CJIS and smart-card questions agency buyers ask
My Dev	Card-lifecycle and provisioning automation around issuance (expansion phase)

Contact	Detail
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15 Appendix — Sources & Notes

This blueprint draws on our May 29, 2026 conversation with Nick Schooler, public sources, and Technijian's research foundation for CardLogix. Company figures (headcount, revenue, endpoint count) are public-signal estimates and are confirmed at discovery. CJIS references are to the FBI CJIS Security Policy and public analyses of versions 5.9.5 and 6.0.

- Conversation with Nick Schooler (CardLogix), May 29, 2026 — confirmed the managed-MFA/CA service as a joint customer-facing offering; the three-wave MFA-adoption framing (federal → state/local → private via cyber-insurance); the phone-MFA (Duo/Okta) displacement thesis; and certificate-based authentication into Microsoft Entra ID.
- CardLogix corporate site — products (PIV, FIDO2, FRAC, BIOSID), markets, services, news room.
- FBI CJIS Security Policy 5.9.5 (2024) — multi-factor authentication mandatory for CJI access as of October 1, 2024.
- FBI CJIS Security Policy 6.0 (December 2024) — tightened password and MFA requirements with phased milestones.
- Public analyses of authentication requirements (phishing-resistant MFA; PKI smart cards and FIDO2 as satisfying controls).
- Competitive references: HID Global, Identiv, Tx Systems, Yubico, and phone-based MFA (Cisco Duo, Okta) — public product and positioning material.
- Companion deliverable: CardLogix Managed-PKI / CloudHSM analysis (AWS vs. Azure CA-grade HSM options).
- Education layer (Section 07): MIT Sloan Management (AI literacy — "what AI can do, not how to build it"); Anthropic, "Building Effective Agents" (the automation/workflow vs. agent distinction); a widely-used five-stage AI maturity model consistent with Gartner and Google Cloud AI-adoption frameworks; U.S. NIST AI Risk Management Framework (Govern / Map / Measure / Manage). Peer-trend examples are representative directions of travel across comparable industries, not Technijian client guarantees.

- Technijian service definitions: My IT, My Security, My Compliance (eight frameworks), My AI, My SEO, My Dev.
- Technijian 2026 rate card (MSA standard schedule) — labor rates (US support, CTO/vCIO advisory, offshore) and managed-services component pricing used as the basis for the Track-A figures. Final pricing is set in a firm quote after the assessment.

Note on CJIS: Technijian does not currently hold a CJIS delivery practice. CJIS is presented throughout as a near-term capability to build on the existing CMMC foundation, triggered by this partnership — never as completed work. All projections are estimated and conservative pending discovery.